

SS Credit: Direct Exterior Access

This credit applies to

- ▶ BD+C: Healthcare (1-4 points)

INTENT

To provide patients, all staff, and visitors with the health benefits of the natural environment by creating outdoor places of respite on the healthcare campus.

REQUIREMENTS

HEALTHCARE

Provide direct access to an exterior courtyard, terrace, garden, or balcony. The space must be at least 5 square feet (0.5 square meters) per patient for 75% of all inpatients and 75% of qualifying outpatients whose clinical length of stay (LOS) exceeds four hours.

Patients whose length of stay exceeds four hours, and whose treatment makes them unable to move, such as emergency, stage 1 surgical recovery, and critical care patients, may be excluded.

Places of respite outside the building envelope that meet the requirements of SS Credit Places of Respite that are immediately adjacent to clinical areas or with direct access from inpatient units may be included.

Qualifying spaces must be designated as nonsmoking. The spaces must also be located more than 100 feet (30 meters) from building exhaust air locations, loading docks, and roadways with idling vehicles.

GUIDANCE

There are no substantive changes to the credit requirements; refer to the LEED v4 reference guide, with the following addition:

Further Explanation

Connection to Ongoing Performance

- ▶ LEED O+M SS Credit Rainwater Management: Rain gardens and other rainwater management features may also serve as outdoor spaces that meet the requirements of this credit.